

CURRENT AFFAIRS



FAILED COUP IN TURKEY



29th WEEK 2016

UPSC

CAPSULE - 2

ALL EXAMS

18th July to 24th July





- *Official ... Republic of Turkey*
- *Major ... Anatolian Peninsula*
- *Minor ... Balkan Peninsula*
- *It is successor to the Ottoman Empire*
- *Republic of Turkey established on 29th Oct, 1923.*
- *First President... Kemal Ataturk*
- *Early member of NATO*

- *Capital ... Ankara*
- *Largest city ... Istanbul*
- *Official language ... Turkish*
- *Largest minority group ... Kurds*
- *Currency ... Turkish Lira*
- *HDI ... 0.761 (high)*
- *Per capita Nominal GDP ... \$ 9,562*
- *Predominantly Sunni Muslim*





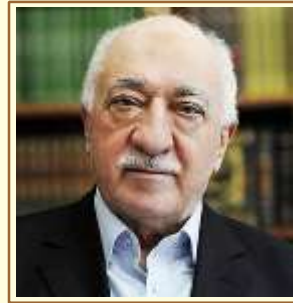


OTHER IMPORTANT ASPECTS

- 1** *Joining EU membership is its dream, But, several EU members objected to it.*
- 2** *It is strategically located in continents of Europe and Asia and it exercises control over entry to Black Sea.*
- 3** *Stability in Turkey is very important, if you look at overall stability in West Asia Region.*
- 4** *It is Parliamentary Republic, but efforts are being made to convert it into Presidential Republic in recent times.*
- 5** *It started off as a secular Republic and in recent times authoritarian President Recep Tayyip Erdogan propagating Islamist politics.*
- 6** *Turkish military, historically known for its Kemalist secularism is quite independent.*



WHAT ARE THE REASONS FOR COUP ATTEMPT ?



FETHULLAH GULEN

- *Military is popular institution with autonomy.*
- *It is known for Kemalist secularism*
- *It staged four successful coups in the past.*
- *Military in 2007 opposed election of Abdullah Gul as President.*



RECEP TAYYIP ERDOGAN, President

- *Becoming more and more authoritative*
- *Imposing Islamist ideology*
- *Stifling institutions, curbs on journalists*
- *However, he enjoy immense popularity.*
- *Antagonised Russia.*
- *Around 2.5 million Syrian refugees are in Turkey.*

WHY THE COUP FAILED IN TOTALITY?

- 1** *Only a minority section of the Armed Forces planned it without support from the top.*
- 2** *Quick response from the Government.*
- 3** *Quick response by the people, who gathered in large numbers on streets.*
- 4** *The news of army rule, martial law created panicky reaction across various sections of people. Hence, everyone is united.*



TURKEY



OVERALL, WHAT WENT WRONG WITH ERDOGAN IN RECENT TIMES?

- 1** *From day 1, he opposed Bashar-al-Assad in Syria. Kept more than 800 kms of borders open, with a view to support Opposition. But ultimately, it benefitted IS for movement of Arms, Ammunition & People.*
 - 2** *There are serious allegations that IS resorted to oil trade with some people in Turkey.*
 - 3** *Turkey is partially responsible for proliferation of IS to some extent.*
 - 4** *Human rights violations, especially in dealing with Kurds.*
 - 5** *Day by day, authoritarian tendencies are growing in Erdogan.*
 - 6** *Country is moving towards Islamist politics in recent times from secularism.*
- Stability of Turkey is of Paramount importance to the World as a whole !***

